

sonality brings strengths and weaknesses to a marriage. I have seldom met a couple where the husband and wife are carbon copies. If you're too similar, one of you is probably unnecessary. Therefore, opposites usually do attract.

3 COMBATANTS OR COMPANIONS?

With rare exception, most couples are so opposite they're predictable. One likes to go to bed late, and one likes to go to bed early. One likes to splash, and the other goes around cleaning up. One has a terrible sense of direction, and the other always knows where they are. One wants to invest and the other wants to spend. I could go on and on because most couples I've met fit the pattern. Opposites *do* attract. But when you use your differences as assets, you'll find that as you communicate about anything, particularly money, you'll get opposite and wise perspectives for making decisions. The goal is to achieve a proper balance in your marriage.

Many times couples will approach their marriage as combatants because of the differences in their personalities. You were attracted to each other because you were different. One of you never talked at a party, and the other never stopped. So the quiet person who would really like to be more outgoing is attracted to the other, because he or she *is* outgoing. But later, if you're not very careful, the very things that attracted you will make you resent your partner. It's really a choice—combatants or companions? You're not going to change the other person's personality, nor should you try.

Through counseling many couples over the years, I had determined that there were four basic personality types with many minor variations. I was in the process of sorting through these and categorizing them when I discovered that someone else had already done this, so I just adopted his method of evaluation.

The four basic traits are Dominant, Influencing, Steady, and Compliant. Each of us possesses some part of all the personal-